

Cooking

Okay this might not interest everybody reading this, but cooking is really a great skill to have and taking it up as a hobby will be a really wise choice. Food is one of the basic necessities that one needs to survive and cooking for friends is a useful social skill. Learning to cook online is really easy as there are tons of recipes and video tutorials available to help you. Many youngsters are opting to go abroad to study or work, and this is perfect for them as they might not always have a cook or might face a situation where cooking might be the only way out. So where should you start with this hobby? Well as <http://www.reluctantgourmet.com> shows us, a basic tomato sauce or mashed potato is where you can start. After this, you can then move on to a simple pasta. Also see <http://busycooks.about.com/od/cookinglessons/a/cookinglessons.htm>, and for Indian cooking: <http://indianfood.about.com>. Once you have mastered the basics, then check out recipe sites, such as: www.indianfoodrecipies.net, www.tarlaladali.com and www.sanjeevkapoor.com where you can find the latest Indian recipes.

Photography

Photography has come a long way from the early box cameras to modern DSLRs, and the future is also looking bright for photography as 3-D cameras are already in research and development. So where does one start off if they want to learn about photography? The beginner's guide at www.photonhead.com takes you through the basics of your camera and also gives you great information about some photographic concepts. Photohead also includes many good advanced tips and tricks for those of you who



Bonus

There is a bonus for those who want to take up photography as a serious hobby as this month we have a Digital SLR comparison test which can be found on page 56 of the magazine. This test will include some great cameras and will help you understand which one is best for you to purchase.

already know the basics and want to learn more about photography.

Visit <http://photobites.blogspot.com/> to learn some advanced photography techniques and improve your skill level.

Even though you read these guides and learn these tricks, putting them to use is important. So anytime you leave your house taking your camera with you is a must. The inspiration for a photograph can just hit you anytime and anywhere. You might see a funny sign board or might even be caught up in a traffic jam when you could take a really great shot of your surroundings.

So what do you do when you have taken your photo? You can



Take advantage of online photography contests

Don't forget to visit

Check out www.casemodgod.com for some of the most insane case mods created by people. Once you mod your case you can always post it on sites like these and get people to go WOW! Other sites worth a visit are – www.mofocases.com, www.neatorama.com, www.modders-inc.com

upload these photos on photo sharing web sites. There is more on that in this issue.

Photography can also be linked to digital art as you can touch up your photo using software such as Photoshop. To know more about how you can touch up your photos visit the web site mentioned in the arts section of this article.

Creative writing / blogging

Blogging is something that most of you might have already started, but did you realise by doing so you are actually increasing your skill at creative writing and in turn are unlocking your imagination? If you are just blogging about your daily routine then you should check out how to improve your writing skills.

Creative writing is fun. Once you get the hang of it, you can write on just about anything. Check out <http://www.dailywritingtips.com/creative-writing-101/> for tips on creative writing.

Mod Casing

Mod Casing is basically any modification you do to a case (computer, console, phone), to change the look of it. This is a very niche hobby, but it is fun in its own way as it involves using tools to break and cut the metal from your cabinet. <http://case-mods.linear1.org/> is a great place to start off if you are new to case modding. This site teaches you from the basics: how to case mod just by doing a paint job on your cabinet to give it a new look. People have gone to great troubles just for this hobby to create unique and simply fantastic case mods. One of our personal favourite mods is the Human Case Mod project where the case was built from a mould of the builder's wife's body!!! But of course, you don't need to start off with something that complex, though it is just phenomenal, the basics that most people start off with entails cutting the side panel of their



Half Life 2 based case mod

computer case and putting a sheet of acrylic to make it transparent done really well at the linear1 web site.

Some of the resources mentioned would definitely draw your attention. Besides, Youtube.com is another great place to learn new hobbies. Users have posted video tutorials on all the above mentioned hobbies. If you actually keep practising your selected hobby or hobbies you might even be able to make it into your career and make money from it. This shows another example of how you can indirectly make money using the internet.

kumar.j@thinkdigit.com